HexaAI Employee Handbook 2026

Document ID: HX-HR-HB-2026 | Version 7.0 | Effective: January 1, 2026 | Owner: People and Culture (VP: Sarah Whitfield) | Internal - applies to all full-time employees

This handbook applies to all full-time HexaAI employees in India, the United States, Germany and Singapore. Where local law gives employees a better benefit, local law wins. Contractors and interns are covered only by Sections 9 and 10 unless their contract says otherwise. All HR requests are raised in **HexaPeople** (people.hexaai.example), HexaAI's HR portal.

1. Working hours and work location

- Standard work week: Monday to Friday, 40 hours (Germany: 38.5 hours per contract). **Core collaboration hours are 11:00 to 16:00 local time**; outside core hours, schedules are flexible.
- **Hybrid policy:** office-assigned employees work from the office **3 days a week - Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday**. Monday and Friday are optional office days.
- Fully remote roles must be approved by a VP and are marked "Remote" in the offer letter. Remote employees must live in a country where HexaAI has an entity (India, US, Germany, Singapore).
- **Work from anywhere:** employees may work from another country for up to **30 calendar days per calendar year**, with manager approval and a tax check by People Ops submitted at least 21 days before travel.
- Overtime: Hourly/non-exempt US employees are paid 1.5x for hours above 40 per week. In India, compensatory off is given for approved weekend work.

2. Probation and notice period

Country	Probation	Notice during probation	Notice after confirmation
India	6 months (extendable once by 3 months)	15 days	60 days (L6 and above: 90 days)
United States	90 days	At-will employment; 2 weeks requested	At-will employment; 2 weeks requested (L6+: 4 weeks)
Germany	6 months	2 weeks (statutory)	3 months to end of a calendar month
Singapore	3 months	1 week	1 month (L6 and above: 2 months)

Notice period buy-out is allowed in India and Singapore with manager and HR approval, at the employee's basic salary for the unserved days. Annual leave cannot be used to shorten the notice period, except up to 5 days with manager approval.

3. Leave policy

3.1 Annual leave (paid time off)

Country	Annual leave per year	Accrual	Carry forward	Encashment
India	24 working days (Privilege Leave)	2 days per month	Up to 10 days into next year; carried days must be used by June 30	Up to 15 unused days paid out at exit, based on basic salary
United States	20 days PTO	1.67 days per month	Up to 5 days; used by March 31	Unused accrued PTO paid at exit (as required in Texas policy)
Germany	28 working days	Full entitlement on Jan 1 (pro-rata in joining year)	Up to 5 days; used by March 31 (statutory)	Only on exit, if leave could not be taken

Country	Annual leave per year	Accrual	Carry forward	Encashment
Singapore	21 working days	1.75 days per month	Up to 7 days; used by June 30	Up to 10 days at exit

- Leave of more than 3 consecutive working days must be applied for in HexaPeople at least **7 calendar days in advance**. Managers must approve or reject within 2 business days; requests not actioned in 5 business days are auto-approved.
- Employees in their first 3 months may take up to 5 days of annual leave in advance of accrual.
- During the December quarter, no more than 30% of any team may be on leave at the same time without director approval.

3.2 Other leave types

Leave type	Entitlement	Rules
Sick leave	India: 12 days; US: 10 days; Germany: statutory (full pay up to 6 weeks per illness); Singapore: 14 days outpatient + 60 days hospitalisation	Medical certificate needed for more than 2 consecutive days (India, Singapore) or from day 3 (Germany). Sick leave does not carry forward and is not encashed.
Casual leave	India only: 6 days per year	Max 2 consecutive days. Cannot be combined with annual leave. Lapses on December 31.
Primary caregiver (parental) leave	26 weeks fully paid (all countries)	For birth, adoption (child under 6 years) or surrogacy. Can start up to 8 weeks before the due date. Must be taken within 12 months of birth/adoption.
Secondary caregiver leave	8 weeks fully paid	Can be split into up to 2 blocks within 12 months of birth/adoption.
Pregnancy loss leave	6 weeks paid	For the employee or partner; no documentation beyond self-declaration.
Bereavement leave	5 days (immediate family); 2 days (extended family)	Immediate family: spouse/partner, child, parent, sibling, parent-in-law.
Marriage leave	5 days, once during employment	Must be taken within 3 months of the marriage date.
Volunteering leave	2 days per year	For registered nonprofit activities; approved by manager.
Exam / study leave	Up to 5 days per year	For exams of HexaAI-sponsored certifications or degrees.
Sabbatical	4 weeks fully paid after 5 years of continuous service	Once every 5 years; must be planned 3 months in advance; can be combined with annual leave up to 6 weeks total.
Leave without pay	Up to 3 months	Requires VP approval; benefits continue except leave accrual.

3.3 Recharge Days and year-end shutdown

- **Recharge Days:** 4 company-wide paid days off per year, on the last Friday of each calendar quarter. In 2026: March 27, June 26, September 25 and December 18 (December moved because of the shutdown).
- **Year-end shutdown:** all HexaAI offices are closed from **December 24, 2026 to January 1, 2027** (inclusive). Shutdown days are paid and are **not deducted** from annual leave. The 24x7 Support team works on a rotation and receives 1.5 days of compensatory leave for each shutdown day worked.
- Recharge Days and shutdown days are in addition to the public holidays listed in Section 4.

4. Public holidays 2026

Each office follows its own holiday calendar. Employees observe the calendar of the office they are assigned to, not the country they travel to. Remote employees follow the calendar of their country of employment. Dates for lunar-calendar holidays are as published by HexaAI People Ops and may be adjusted after the official government gazette.

4.1 India - Bengaluru (13 fixed holidays + 2 optional)

#	Date	Holiday
1	Jan 1, 2026 (Thursday)	New Year's Day (covered by year-end shutdown)
2	Jan 14, 2026 (Wednesday)	Makar Sankranti / Pongal
3	Jan 26, 2026 (Monday)	Republic Day
4	Mar 4, 2026 (Wednesday)	Holi
5	Mar 19, 2026 (Thursday)	Ugadi
6	Apr 3, 2026 (Friday)	Good Friday
7	May 1, 2026 (Friday)	May Day / Labour Day
8	Aug 15, 2026 (Saturday)	Independence Day
9	Sep 14, 2026 (Monday)	Ganesh Chaturthi
10	Oct 2, 2026 (Friday)	Gandhi Jayanti
11	Oct 20, 2026 (Tuesday)	Vijayadashami (Dussehra)
12	Nov 9, 2026 (Monday)	Deepavali
13	Dec 25, 2026 (Friday)	Christmas Day

Optional holidays (India): employees may choose **any 2** from: Eid-ul-Fitr (March 21), Mahavir Jayanti (March 31), Eid-ul-Adha (May 27), Muharram (June 16), Raksha Bandhan (August 28), Onam (August 26), Guru Nanak Jayanti (November 24). Optional holidays must be booked at least 14 days in advance and do not carry forward.

4.2 United States - Austin (10 fixed holidays + 2 floating)

#	Date	Holiday
1	Jan 1, 2026 (Thursday)	New Year's Day
2	Jan 19, 2026 (Monday)	Martin Luther King Jr. Day
3	Feb 16, 2026 (Monday)	Presidents' Day
4	May 25, 2026 (Monday)	Memorial Day
5	Jun 19, 2026 (Friday)	Juneteenth
6	Jul 3, 2026 (Friday)	Independence Day (observed; July 4 is a Saturday)
7	Sep 7, 2026 (Monday)	Labor Day
8	Nov 26, 2026 (Thursday)	Thanksgiving Day
9	Nov 27, 2026 (Friday)	Day after Thanksgiving
10	Dec 25, 2026 (Friday)	Christmas Day

Floating holidays (US): 2 per calendar year, any date, booked at least 14 days in advance; not carried forward and not paid out at exit. When a US holiday falls on a Saturday it is observed on the Friday before; on a Sunday, the Monday after.

4.3 Germany - Berlin (10 holidays)

#	Date	Holiday
1	Jan 1, 2026 (Thursday)	Neujahr (New Year's Day)

#	Date	Holiday
2	Mar 9, 2026 (Monday)	Internationaler Frauentag (Berlin) - observed on Monday by HexaAI
3	Apr 3, 2026 (Friday)	Karfreitag (Good Friday)
4	Apr 6, 2026 (Monday)	Ostermontag (Easter Monday)
5	May 1, 2026 (Friday)	Tag der Arbeit (Labour Day)
6	May 14, 2026 (Thursday)	Christi Himmelfahrt (Ascension Day)
7	May 25, 2026 (Monday)	Pfingstmontag (Whit Monday)
8	Oct 3, 2026 (Saturday)	Tag der Deutschen Einheit (German Unity Day)
9	Dec 25, 2026 (Friday)	1. Weihnachtstag (Christmas Day)
10	Dec 26, 2026 (Saturday)	2. Weihnachtstag (Boxing Day)

In Germany there are no floating holidays; instead, December 24 and December 31 are already covered by the year-end shutdown.

4.4 Singapore (11 holidays)

#	Date	Holiday
1	Jan 1, 2026 (Thursday)	New Year's Day
2	Feb 17, 2026 (Tuesday)	Chinese New Year (Day 1)
3	Feb 18, 2026 (Wednesday)	Chinese New Year (Day 2)
4	Mar 20, 2026 (Friday)	Hari Raya Puasa
5	Apr 3, 2026 (Friday)	Good Friday
6	May 1, 2026 (Friday)	Labour Day
7	May 27, 2026 (Wednesday)	Hari Raya Haji
8	Jun 1, 2026 (Monday)	Vesak Day (observed)
9	Aug 10, 2026 (Monday)	National Day (observed; August 9 is a Sunday)
10	Nov 9, 2026 (Monday)	Deepavali (observed)
11	Dec 25, 2026 (Friday)	Christmas Day

4.5 Working on a public holiday

- Employees asked to work on a public holiday get **one compensatory day off** to be used within 60 days, or (India and Singapore hourly staff) double pay for the day.
- In India and Germany, holidays that fall on a weekend are **not** moved to a weekday, except where HexaAI explicitly lists an observed date.

5. Compensation, performance and equity

- **Payroll:** India, Germany and Singapore are paid monthly on the last working day of the month. US employees are paid bi-weekly on Fridays.
- **Levels:** L1 Associate, L2 Engineer/Specialist, L3 Senior, L4 Staff/Lead, L5 Principal/Manager, L6 Senior Manager/Director, L7 Senior Director, L8 Vice President.
- **Performance cycle:** annual review in April (self-review, manager review, calibration); mid-year check-in in October. Ratings on a 5-point scale: 1 Below expectations, 2 Partially meets, 3 Meets, 4 Exceeds, 5 Outstanding.
- **Salary increments** are effective **July 1** each year. Promotions are effective April 1 or October 1.

- **Annual bonus targets** (% of base salary): L1-L4: 10%; L5-L6: 15%; L7-L8: 25%. Payout ranges from 0% to 200% of target based on company performance (50% weight) and individual rating (50% weight). Paid in the June payroll. Employees must be employed on the payout date and have joined before January 1 of the review year.
- **ESOPs:** all full-time employees are eligible. Standard vesting is 4 years with a 1-year cliff: 25% vests after 12 months, the rest monthly over 36 months. Vested options can be exercised up to 5 years after leaving.
- **Referral bonus:** INR 75,000 (India), USD 3,000 (US), EUR 2,500 (Germany) or SGD 3,500 (Singapore) for engineering and research hires; half of these amounts for other roles. Paid after the new hire completes 90 days.

6. Benefits

Benefit	India	United States	Germany	Singapore
Health insurance	Group mediclaim INR 10 lakh family floater (self, spouse, 2 children, 2 parents or parents-in-law); top-up available	Medical, dental, vision: HexaAI pays 100% of employee premium and 80% for dependents	Statutory health insurance + HexaAI supplementary dental	Group medical SGD 150,000 per year + dental SGD 500
Life insurance	3x annual CTC	2x base salary	2x base salary	3x base salary
Retirement	PF as per law (12% of basic)	401(k) with 100% match up to 4% of salary	Statutory pension + company-paid pension of EUR 100 per month	CPF as per law
Wellness	INR 30,000 per year	USD 600 per year	EUR 500 per year	SGD 800 per year
Home internet	INR 1,500 per month	USD 60 per month	EUR 40 per month	SGD 60 per month
Home office setup (one-time)	INR 25,000	USD 500	EUR 450	SGD 600

- **Learning budget:** USD 1,500 per year (India: INR 100,000) for courses, books and certifications, plus one conference per year (travel paid separately for speakers). Unused budget does not carry over. Employees who leave within 12 months of a reimbursement above USD 1,000 must repay 50%.
- **Equipment:** every employee gets a 14-inch MacBook Pro (or a Linux ThinkPad on request), refreshed every **3 years**, plus one external monitor. Equipment must be returned within 7 days of the last working day.
- **Meals:** free lunch on office days in Bengaluru and Singapore; USD 20 / EUR 15 meal allowance per office day in Austin and Berlin.

7. Travel and expense policy

Item	Policy
Flights	Economy for flights under 6 hours; premium economy for flights of 6 hours or more; business class only for flights over 10 hours and for L7 and above. Book at least 14 days in advance through the HexaTravel portal.
Hotels (max per night)	Bengaluru INR 8,000; Mumbai INR 10,000; Delhi INR 9,000; Austin USD 250; New York / San Francisco USD 350; Berlin EUR 180; Singapore SGD 300; elsewhere USD 220
Per diem (meals and incidentals)	India INR 2,500 per day; US USD 75 per day; EU EUR 60 per day; Singapore SGD 90 per day
Local transport	Taxi or ride-share allowed; car rental needs manager approval; personal car mileage INR 12/km, USD 0.67/mile, EUR 0.30/km
Client entertainment	Up to USD 100 per person (INR 5,000 in India); alcohol is not reimbursable in India
Submission	Submit expenses with receipts in HexaPeople within 30 days of the expense. Expenses older than 90 days are not reimbursed.
Approval	Manager approves up to USD 2,000 per claim; above USD 2,000 needs VP approval; above USD 10,000 needs CFO approval

Item	Policy
Reimbursement	Paid in the next payroll cycle after approval

8. Code of conduct (summary)

- **Gifts:** employees may accept gifts worth up to USD 100 (INR 5,000) per year from any single vendor or customer. Anything above must be declared in HexaPeople within 5 days.
- **Conflicts of interest:** must be disclosed to People Ops and Legal within 15 days of becoming aware of them.
- **Side projects / moonlighting:** allowed only with written approval from the employee's VP and Legal; never for competitors or HexaAI customers.
- **Anti-harassment:** zero tolerance. Complaints go to the Internal Committee (India POSH) at ic@hexaai.example or the anonymous Ethics Hotline. Investigations start within 7 days.
- **Disciplinary process:** verbal warning, written warning, Performance Improvement Plan (PIP, 60 days), then termination. Gross misconduct (fraud, violence, data theft) can lead to immediate termination.

9. Information security rules for employees

- MFA is mandatory for all company systems; hardware security keys are mandatory for Engineering and Finance.
- Customer data must never be copied to personal devices, personal cloud storage or public AI tools. Use HexaChat (internal tenant) for AI assistance.
- Report suspected phishing or a lost device to security@hexaai.example or #sec-help on Slack **within 1 hour**.
- Security awareness training is mandatory within 14 days of joining and every 12 months after. Missing it for more than 30 days blocks access to production systems.
- Laptops must have disk encryption on and must auto-lock after 5 minutes of inactivity.

10. Exit process

- Resignations are submitted in HexaPeople; the notice period starts the next calendar day.
- Full and final settlement (India) is paid within 45 days of the last working day; US final pay follows state law.
- Experience and relieving letters are issued within 7 days after the full and final settlement.
- Employees who leave in good standing are eligible for rehire after 6 months.